

Dynamic Application Security Testing Using Acunetix and GuardRails

Dynamic application security testing (DAST) focuses on finding security vulnerabilities in a web application while it is running. This article looks at Acunetix and GuardRails, which are two popular DAST tools.



Security controls are integrated into the DevOps process through a method called DevSecOps. This includes integrating security early in the software development life cycle (SDLC). Additionally, DevSecOps enhances cooperation between the development and operations teams by including security teams into the software delivery process. Security becomes a shared responsibility under DevSecOps, which calls for changes in technologies, processes, and culture across the SDLC key functional teams. The DevOps continuous integration and continuous delivery (CI/CD) process must incorporate security, and everyone participating in the SDLC has a part to play.

Testing, triage, and risk mitigation should be included early in the CI/CD workflow to avoid the time-consuming and frequently expensive consequences of making a patch after the event. This idea is a component of 'shifting left', which brings security testing closer to programmers so that they may address security flaws in their code almost immediately rather than 'bolting

on security' at the end of the software development life cycle (SDLC). DevSecOps integrates real-time continuous feedback loops and insights throughout the whole SDLC, from planning and design through coding, building, testing, and release.

Dynamic application security testing (DAST)

Dynamic application security testing (DAST) is used to investigate a web application and find vulnerabilities using simulated attacks. This type of technique evaluates the software from the 'outside in' by attacking an application just as a malicious user might. A DAST scanner looks for results that do not match the intended result set after the execution of these attacks in order to identify security issues. DAST has the advantage of identifying potential security holes without taking the application into account. And it does not require access to the source code. The disadvantages are that it cannot determine the exact position of a code vulnerability and that security knowledge is needed to interpret reports.